COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Structure of Government & Constitutional Development, 1757-1858 - Solved Practice Workbook

Solved Practice Workbook

MODERN HISTORY - TOPIC 06

Structure of Government & Constitutional Development, 1757-1858

Regulating Act 1773 to the Government of India Act 1858 | GS-I Modern Indian History | Date: 2026-08-19

FOCUS

1773-1858: Regulating Act, Supreme Court and jurisdiction, Act of Settlement 1781, Pitt's India Act 1784, Act of 1786, Charter Acts 1793/1813/1833/1853, and the Government of India Act 1858.

EVIDENCE

Repository basic/advanced Topic 06; Bipin Chandra's Modern India and Sekhar Bandyopadhyay's From Plassey to Partition; official 2019 and 2023 Prelims papers.

EXAM MOVE

Prelims: hold Governor-General of Bengal vs India vs Viceroy precisely. Mains: read this as parliamentary control over a corporation, not a liberal reform story.

CAUTION

No invented statutory wording, no fabricated PYQ key, no borrowing of Topic 04/07/08/09/11/12 material -- boundaries are held throughout; both PYQs are labelled where unverified.

Original deterministic study visual - Modern History Topic 06

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Structure of Government & Constitutional Development, 1757-1858 - Solved Practice Workbook

These **32 Workbook MCQs** are fully distinct from the 16 Learning MCQs. Every fourth slot is remedial, remediation is folded inside the same locked 32-question bank, and the answer key rotates **A -> B -> C -> D** exactly eight times.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Workbook MCQ 01. The Patna Case (1777-79) and the Cossijurah Case (1779-80) both illustrate which underlying structural problem?

A. The Supreme Court's undefined jurisdiction overlapping with the Company's own courts and revenue administration -- Patna in personal-law/civil-court territory, Cossijurah in revenue-administration territory B. A conflict between the Bengal Council and the Board of Control C. A dispute purely about the personal conduct of Warren Hastings D. A rebellion by zamindars against Company rule

Answer: A. [Q01-A] A Correct: both cases exposed overlap between Supreme Court reach and Company judicial-revenue power. [Q01-B] B Board of Control came only in 1784, so it cannot explain the 1777-80 clashes. [Q01-C] C The issue was structural jurisdiction, not Hastings's private conduct. [Q01-D] D Neither case was a zamindari revolt; both were legal-administrative confrontations.

Trap: Naming every court clash after Hastings instead of the jurisdiction problem.

Workbook MCQ 02. How did Pitt's India Act, 1784 change the size of the Bengal Council, and with what structural effect?

A. It left the Council's size unchanged but gave the Governor-General a casting vote for the first time B. It reduced the Council from a Governor-General-plus-four to a Governor-General-plus-three, meaning the Governor-General now needed only one ally for a working majority C. It enlarged the Council to six members, making consensus even harder to reach D. It abolished the Council entirely, leaving the Governor-General to rule alone

Answer: B. [Q02-A] A The reform changed council size, not merely a casting-vote rule. [Q02-B] B Correct: 1784 reduced the council from GG+4 to GG+3, so one ally now sufficed. [Q02-C] C No six-member expansion occurred in 1784. [Q02-D] D The Council survived; only its arithmetic changed.

Trap: Mistaking a structural shrink for a voting-procedure tweak.

Workbook MCQ 03. Which of the following correctly distinguishes Bengal's Dual Government from Pitt's India Act's "dual control"?

A. The Dual Government continued unchanged until 1858, running parallel to dual control B. They are two names for the exact same institution, just at different dates C. The Dual Government (1765-72, Nawab's Nizamat vs Company's Diwani, Bengal) and dual control (from 1784, Board of Control vs Court of Directors, both based in Britain) are different institutions, in different decades, located in different places D. Dual control refers only to Bengal's own internal administration after 1784

Answer: C. [Q03-A] A Dual Government ended in 1772; it did not continue to 1858. [Q03-B] B They are not two names for one system. [Q03-C] C Correct: decade, location and institutions all differ. [Q03-D] D Dual control was London-based, not only Bengal-internal.

Trap: Letting the word dual erase two different constitutional arrangements.

Workbook MCQ 04. A student writes: "The Regulating Act, 1773 created the post of Governor-General of India." What is the correct remedial statement?

A. The Regulating Act created the office of Viceroy, not Governor-General B. The statement is entirely correct as written C. The Regulating Act applied this title only to Madras, not Bengal D. The Regulating Act created the Governor-General of Fort William (Bengal), a Bengal-specific office with no all-India scope; the Governor-General of India title arrives only with the Charter Act of 1833

Answer: D. [Q04-A] A Viceroy is a later 1858 title, not a 1773 one. [Q04-B] B The student statement is the error being corrected. [Q04-C] C The office began in Bengal, not Madras. [Q04-D] D Correct: 1773 created GG of Fort William/Bengal; GG of India arrives only in 1833.

Trap: Collapsing Bengal Governor-General, all-India Governor-General and Viceroy into one office.

Workbook MCQ 05. What was the Charter Act of 1793's principal distinctive contribution?

A. Renewing the Company's charter and trade monopoly for twenty years, and codifying Cornwallis-era Bengal regulations into a systematised, translated body of law B. Ending the Company's trade monopoly entirely C. Creating the office of Governor-General of India D. Creating the Board of Control for the first time

Answer: A. [Q05-A] A Correct: 1793 renewed the charter for twenty years and codified Cornwallis-era regulations. [Q05-B] B Full commercial wind-up came in 1833, not 1793. [Q05-C] C GG of India was created in 1833, not by the 1793 renewal. [Q05-D] D Board of Control already existed from 1784.

Trap: Reading every Charter Act as trade liberalisation instead of seeing 1793 as continuation.

Workbook MCQ 06. The Charter Act, 1813 also included which further provision, distinct from the trade provision?

A. The introduction of open competitive examinations for the civil service B. An assertion of the "undoubted sovereignty of the Crown of the United Kingdom" over the Company's Indian territories, alongside permission for missionaries to enter and preach, and a one-lakh-rupee education grant C. The direct abolition of the Company's Court of Directors D. The creation of a Legislative Council with additional members

Answer: B. [Q06-A] A Open competition belongs to 1853-55, not to 1813. [Q06-B] B Correct: 1813 also asserted Crown sovereignty, permitted missionaries and earmarked one lakh for education. [Q06-C] C Court of Directors survived until 1858. [Q06-D] D Additional legislative members belong to 1853, not 1813.

Trap: Reducing 1813 to trade and forgetting its sovereignty-mission-education bundle.

Workbook MCQ 07. Which two new features did the Charter Act, 1833 add to the Governor-General's Council?

A. A Secretary of State and a Council of India B. A Viceroy and an enlarged Legislative Council with additional members C. A fourth, Law Member (first held by Thomas Babington Macaulay) and a Law Commission tasked with codifying Indian law D. A Board of Control and a Secret Committee

Answer: C. [Q07-A] A Secretary of State and Council of India belong to 1858. [Q07-B] B Viceroy is 1858; additional legislative members are 1853. [Q07-C] C Correct: 1833 added the Law Member and Law Commission. [Q07-D] D Board of Control and Secret Committee belong to 1784.

Trap: Mixing 1784, 1853 and 1858 institutions into one imaginary 1833 package.

Workbook MCQ 08. A student writes: "Pitt's India Act's 1784 'dual control' is the same institution as Bengal's 1765-72 Dual Government." What is the correct remedial statement?

A. The Dual Government continued unchanged as part of dual control until 1858 B. The statement is correct; both refer to the same Board of Control structure C. Dual control replaced the Dual Government directly in 1772 D. These are two entirely distinct institutions -- the Dual Government (Nawab's Nizamat vs Company's Diwani, Bengal, 1765-72, Topic 04) and dual control (Board of Control vs Court of Directors, both based in Britain, from 1784) -- sharing only the loose word "dual"

Answer: D. [Q08-A] A Dual Government did not continue unchanged to 1858. [Q08-B] B Board of Control belongs only to the 1784 scheme. [Q08-C] C Dual control was created in 1784, not in 1772. [Q08-D] D Correct:

Dual Government and dual control differ in date, location and institutional pair.

Trap: Using one remembered label to fuse unrelated institutions.

Workbook MCQ 09. Which of the following correctly describes a structural feature of the Charter Act, 1853?

A. It enlarged the Governor-General's Council for legislative purposes by adding additional legislative members (including Supreme Court judges and presidency representatives), distinct from the smaller executive Council B. It fixed a new twenty-year renewal term, like every earlier Charter Act C. It abolished the office of Governor-General D. It created the Board of Control for the first time

Answer: A. [Q09-A] A Correct: legislative members were added for law-making, distinct from the executive council. [Q09-B] B 1853 had no fresh twenty-year term; it continued only until Parliament otherwise provided. [Q09-C] C The Governor-General's office continued. [Q09-D] D Board of Control was created in 1784.

Trap: Projecting earlier fixed-term Charter Acts onto the exceptional 1853 Act.

Workbook MCQ 10. What specific financial event forced the East India Company to approach the British government in 1772?

A. The Company's own gold reserves were seized by the Nawab of Bengal B. A cash crisis threatening the Company's solvency, leading it to request an emergency loan (understood in this topic's own terms as arranged through Bank of England channels) C. A trade embargo imposed by France D. A currency devaluation ordered by the Mughal emperor

Answer: B. [Q10-A] A No seizure of Company gold by the Nawab triggered the 1772 crisis. [Q10-B] B Correct: a solvency-threatening cash crisis and loan request brought Parliament in. [Q10-C] C A French embargo is not part of this causal chain. [Q10-D] D The Mughal emperor did not request Westminster legislation.

Trap: Replacing the documented loan crisis with an unsupported geopolitical story.

Workbook MCQ 11. The Regulating Act's language on presidency subordination to Bengal covered which matters?

A. All administrative matters without any exception whatsoever B. Only commercial and trading matters C. War and peace-related matters, subject to a narrower and more ambiguous "except in emergency situations"-type qualification later widened by Pitt's India Act, 1784 D. Only matters of religious administration

Answer: C. [Q11-A] A 1773 did not subordinate every branch of administration absolutely. [Q11-B] B The clause was not about commerce. [Q11-C] C Correct: it covered war and peace, with narrower wording than the later 1784 position. [Q11-D] D Religion was not the field covered here.

Trap: Overstating 1773 as full administrative centralisation.

Workbook MCQ 12. A student writes: "The Charter Act of 1813 ended the Company's monopoly over all trade, with no exceptions at all." What is the correct remedial statement?

A. The statement is correct; no exceptions existed B. The 1813 Act preserved the Company's monopoly over all trade without any change C. The exceptions applied only to Bengal, not to Madras or Bombay D. The 1813 Act ended the Company's trade monopoly in India for other British subjects while specifically preserving the Company's exclusive monopoly over tea and all China trade

Answer: D. [Q12-A] A A total end to monopoly in 1813 is the common error. [Q12-B] B 1813 certainly changed the trade regime; it was not a no-change Act. [Q12-C] C The exceptions were substantive trade exceptions, not presidency-wise ones. [Q12-D] D Correct: Indian trade opened except for tea and China trade.

Trap: Remembering monopoly ended and dropping the tea-China exception UPSC tests.

Workbook MCQ 13. Which office, established under the 1774 Charter, gave the Supreme Court at Calcutta its first Chief Justice?

A. Sir Elijah Impey B. Warren Hastings himself C. Thomas Babington Macaulay D. Lord Cornwallis

Answer: A. [Q13-A] A Correct: Elijah Impey was the first Chief Justice. [Q13-B] B Hastings was Governor-General, not Chief Justice. [Q13-C] C Macaulay is tied to 1833, not to the 1774 Court. [Q13-D] D Cornwallis belongs to the 1786 executive story.

Trap: Choosing a famous name instead of the office-holder attached to 1774.

Workbook MCQ 14. The Amending Act of 1781 directed the Supreme Court to apply which law in personal-law matters?

A. No law at all -- personal-law matters were entirely excluded from any court B. Hindu law to Hindus and Muslim law to Muslims, specifically in matters such as marriage, inheritance, caste usage and religious practice C. French civil law, following the Chandernagore precedent D. English common law uniformly to all litigants regardless of religion

Answer: B. [Q14-A] A Personal-law disputes were not expelled from courts altogether. [Q14-B] B Correct: 1781 required Hindu law for Hindus and Muslim law for Muslims in personal-law matters. [Q14-C] C French civil law had no role in the 1781 settlement. [Q14-D] D 1781 did not impose uniform English law regardless of religion.

Trap: Assuming colonial legality meant one English-law rule for everyone.

Workbook MCQ 15. What was the function of the Secret Committee created alongside the Board of Control in 1784?

A. To supervise missionary activity in India B. To codify Bengal's regulations into a printed body of law C. To provide a channel for the Board's urgent or confidential orders to reach the Company's Court of Directors without full deliberation by the whole Court D. To try capital criminal cases in Bengal

Answer: C. [Q15-A] A Missionary entry is tied to 1813, not to the Secret Committee. [Q15-B] B Bengal-regulation codification belongs elsewhere, not to this 1784 body. [Q15-C] C Correct: it carried urgent/confidential Board orders without full Court deliberation. [Q15-D] D It was an administrative conduit, not a criminal court.

Trap: Treating every 1784 institution as generic oversight and missing the communication machinery.

Workbook MCQ 16. A student writes: "The Charter Act of 1833 ended only some of the Company's commercial activities, while allowing limited trade to continue." What is the correct remedial statement?

A. The Company's commercial activity was never affected by any Charter Act B. The statement is correct; limited tea trade continued after 1833 C. Commercial activity ended only in 1858, not in 1833 D. The 1833 Act ended all of the Company's remaining commercial and trading activities outright, converting it into a purely administrative body holding its territories in trust for the Crown

Answer: D. [Q16-A] A Charter Acts did affect commerce, and 1833 finished the process. [Q16-B] B Tea-trade continuation belongs to 1813, not post-1833. [Q16-C] C Commercial activity ended before 1858. [Q16-D] D Correct: 1833 ended all remaining Company trade and left it administrative only.

Trap: Carrying 1813's partial opening forward and missing 1833's total commercial break.

Workbook MCQ 17. Lord Cornwallis, appointed Governor-General in 1786, combined that office with which other position?

A. Commander-in-Chief, unifying civil and military command in Bengal for the first time under statute B. President of the Court of Directors C. Chairman of the Board of Control D. Chief Justice of the Supreme Court

Answer: A. [Q17-A] A Correct: Cornwallis combined Governor-General with Commander-in-Chief. [Q17-B] B Presidency of the Court of Directors was a London office, not Cornwallis's Indian role. [Q17-C] C The Board of Control was a British supervisory body, not his second office. [Q17-D] D Chief Justice was a separate judicial office.

Trap: Confusing metropolitan posts with the strengthened Indian executive.

Workbook MCQ 18. What was the size and purpose of the education-related grant introduced by the Charter Act, 1813?

A. Ten lakh rupees, for direct construction of English-medium schools B. One lakh rupees a year, statutorily earmarked for "the revival and promotion of literature and the encouragement of the learned natives of India" and useful scientific knowledge, though actual disbursement was delayed for years C. Fifty thousand rupees, for missionary institutions exclusively D. Five lakh rupees, disbursed immediately and fully upon the Act's passage

Answer: B. [Q18-A] A The grant was not ten lakhs for direct school building. [Q18-B] B Correct: one lakh annually was earmarked, but spending lagged. [Q18-C] C It was not fifty thousand nor missionary-only. [Q18-D] D It was not five lakhs, nor was it fully disbursed at once.

Trap: Remembering only education grant and forgetting amount plus delay.

Workbook MCQ 19. After the Charter Act of 1833, what was the Company's own legal status regarding trade?

A. It retained a reduced but still active trading role limited to tea and China B. It expanded its commercial activity to compensate for reduced administrative duties C. It became a purely administrative, non-commercial body holding its Indian possessions in trust for the Crown, with all commercial activity ended outright D. It was permitted to trade freely in India but not with China

Answer: C. [Q19-A] A Tea and China were the 1813 exceptions; after 1833 active trade ended. [Q19-B] B 1833 did not expand trade. [Q19-C] C Correct: the Company became a purely administrative, non-commercial body. [Q19-D] D It did not keep a reduced India-trade role after 1833.

Trap: Treating 1833 as a minor regulatory trim instead of the decisive commercial break.

Workbook MCQ 20. A student writes: "The Charter Act of 1853 itself instantly introduced full, operating competitive examinations for the Indian Civil Service." What is the correct remedial statement?

A. The statement is correct as written B. No competitive examination was ever held before 1858 C. Competitive examinations were introduced by the Regulating Act of 1773 D. The 1853 Act ended patronage nomination and opened the principle of competition only; the 1854 Macaulay Committee designed the actual mechanism, and the first competitive examination was held only in 1855

Answer: D. [Q20-A] A The student claim is exactly what must be corrected. [Q20-B] B Competitive exams were held before 1858; the first came in 1855. [Q20-C] C 1773 had nothing to do with competitive recruitment. [Q20-D] D Correct: 1853 opened the principle, 1854 designed it, 1855 held the first exam.

Trap: Collapsing statute, committee and first exam into the single date 1853.

Workbook MCQ 21. The Charter Act of 1833's non-discrimination clause specifically barred disqualification from Company office on which grounds?

A. Religion, place of birth, descent or colour B. Educational qualification alone C. Prior criminal record only D. Age and gender only

Answer: A. [Q21-A] A Correct: the clause lists religion, place of birth, descent and colour. [Q21-B] B Educational qualification is not the clause's wording. [Q21-C] C Criminal record is not what this clause enumerates. [Q21-D] D Age and gender are not its protected grounds.

Trap: Paraphrasing the 1833 clause so loosely that its exact protected grounds disappear.

Workbook MCQ 22. What was the specific function of the 1854 Macaulay Committee, distinct from the Charter Act of 1853 itself?

A. It negotiated the Treaty of Allahabad B. It designed the syllabus, age limits and administrative rules for competitive civil-service recruitment under the principle the 1853 Act had opened C. It drafted the Charter Act of 1858 D. It tried Nand Kumar's forgery case

Answer: B. [Q22-A] A Treaty of Allahabad belongs to 1765, not to civil-service competition. [Q22-B] B Correct: the 1854 committee designed syllabus, age limits and rules under the 1853 principle. [Q22-C] C It did not draft the 1858 Act. [Q22-D] D Nand Kumar's case belongs to 1775, not to recruitment reform.

Trap: Treating the committee as the statute instead of the implementation step.

Workbook MCQ 23. Alongside Company rule itself, which two supervisory bodies did the Government of India Act, 1858 abolish?

A. The Supreme Court and the Sadar Diwani Adalat B. The Legislative Council and the Law Commission C. The Board of Control (created 1784) and the Company's own Court of Directors D. The Regulating Act's Council and the Amending Act's provisions

Answer: C. [Q23-A] A 1858 did not specifically abolish those two courts as the paired supervisory bodies asked here. [Q23-B] B Legislative Council and Law Commission were not the twin supervisory organs removed in 1858. [Q23-C] C Correct: the Board of Control and Court of Directors disappeared with Company rule. [Q23-D] D Acts and provisions are not the institutions being asked for.

Trap: Naming familiar institutions but missing the apex machinery 1858 actually removed.

Workbook MCQ 24. A student writes: "The Government of India Act, 1858 and the Queen's Proclamation of 1858 are the same single document." What is the correct remedial statement?

A. The Proclamation was issued decades before the Act B. The Act contains the amnesty provisions, and the Proclamation contains the abolition of the Company C. The statement is correct; both were issued as one combined text D. They are two distinct instruments -- the Act is the constitutional-legal transfer instrument passed by Parliament; the Proclamation (1 November 1858) is a separate political-policy announcement with its own distinct promises (religious non-interference, treaty recognition, formal equality before law, qualified amnesty)

Answer: D. [Q24-A] A The Proclamation followed the Act in 1858, not decades before it. [Q24-B] B Abolition of Company rule is Act-content; amnesty and treaty assurances are Proclamation-content. [Q24-C] C They were related but distinct instruments, not one merged text. [Q24-D] D Correct: the Act transferred sovereignty; the Proclamation separately announced policy promises.

Trap: Folding all 1858 changes into one imaginary document.

Workbook MCQ 25. Lord Canning, already Governor-General since 1856, became the first holder of which combined title in 1858?

A. Governor-General and Viceroy of India, combined B. Secretary of State for India C. Chairman of the Board of Control D. President of the Council of India

Answer: A. [Q25-A] A Correct: Canning became Governor-General and Viceroy together. [Q25-B] B Secretary of State was a London cabinet office, not Canning's combined Indian title. [Q25-C] C The Board of Control was abolished in 1858. [Q25-D] D President of the Council of India was not the added Indian office.

Trap: Confusing the new London authority with the continued Indian executive title.

Workbook MCQ 26. Which pairing correctly keeps this topic's executive-centralisation and legislative-centralisation tracks separate?

A. Both tracks are identical and interchangeable at every date B. Executive: Governor-General of Bengal (1773) -> smaller Council (1784) -> bounded override (1786) -> Governor-General of India (1833) -> Governor-General-and-Viceroy (1858); Legislative: no distinct body -> all-India legislative monopoly under the Governor-General-in-Council (1833) -> a Council enlarged specifically for legislative business (1853) C. The legislative track precedes the executive track by fifty years D. Executive centralisation began only in 1858, with no earlier steps

Answer: B. [Q26-A] A Executive and legislative centralisation are related but not identical tracks. [Q26-B] B Correct: it separates office-strengthening from law-making centralisation. [Q26-C] C The legislative track did not precede the executive one by fifty years. [Q26-D] D Executive centralisation began well before 1858.

Trap: Compressing every constitutional change into one vague centralisation timeline.

Workbook MCQ 27. Across the entire 1757-1858 period examined in this topic, which statement about Indian representation in central legislative or executive bodies is correct?

A. Indian representation began with the Charter Act of 1833's non-discrimination clause B. Indian representation was fully achieved by the Government of India Act, 1858 C. No Indian individual sat on the Governor-General's Council, the 1853 enlarged Legislative Council, the Board of Control, or the 1858 Council of India D. Indians formed a majority on the 1853 Legislative Council

Answer: C. [Q27-A] A 1833 removed a formal bar but gave no Indian central-council seat. [Q27-B] B 1858 still did not create Indian representation in these apex bodies. [Q27-C] C Correct: Indians sat on none of the listed central bodies through 1858. [Q27-D] D Indians certainly did not form a majority on the 1853 Legislative Council.

Trap: Mistaking eligibility language for actual legislative-executive representation.

Workbook MCQ 28. A student writes: "This topic's own coverage includes the Indian Councils Act of 1861 and later representative-council reforms." What is the correct remedial statement?

A. Topic 06 and Topic 12 cover identical, fully overlapping material B. The statement is correct; 1861 is this topic's own final Act C. The Indian Councils Act of 1861 actually predates the Regulating Act of 1773 D. This topic's constitutional coverage ends at the 1858 Act and its accompanying Proclamation; the Indian Councils Act of 1861 and later representative reforms belong to Topic 12 (post-1858 councils and Crown administration)

Answer: D. [Q28-A] A Topic 06 and Topic 12 are linked, not identical. [Q28-B] B 1861 is not this period's final Act. [Q28-C] C 1861 obviously postdates 1773, so this chronology is impossible. [Q28-D] D Correct: Topic 06 ends at 1858/Proclamation; 1861 belongs to Topic 12.

Trap: Letting later Crown-period council reforms leak back into the Company-era period.

Workbook MCQ 29. The reading that Company financial crisis, parliamentary patronage anxiety and political accountability concerns -- not humanitarian motive -- drove the 1772-73 intervention follows which broad historiographical tradition, as used consistently in this topic's own narrative?

A. A critical political-economy reading, associated with historians such as Bipan Chandra B. A reading found only in colonial-era official correspondence C. A purely legal-formalist reading with no attention to political economy D. A reading that denies any British parliamentary involvement occurred at all

Answer: A. [Q29-A] A Correct: this is the political-economy lens associated with Bipan Chandra. [Q29-B] B This explanation is not confined to colonial officials alone. [Q29-C] C A purely legal-formalist reading would miss the fiscal and patronage logic. [Q29-D] D The reading does not deny intervention; it explains why Parliament intervened.

Trap: Calling the anti-humanitarian reading administrative history instead of political economy.

Workbook MCQ 30. Which historiographical lens connects the Charter Act of 1813's trade opening and the Charter Act of 1833's full commercial wind-up to Britain's own domestic shift from mercantilist monopoly toward industrial free trade?

A. The company-state/corporate-sovereignty reading B. The free-trade/industrial-capital transition reading, emphasising British manufacturing and mercantile lobbying against the Company's chartered privileges C. The administrative/rule-of-law maturation reading D. The critical political-economy reading of the 1772-73 crisis specifically

Answer: B. [Q30-A] A The company-state lens stresses hybrid sovereignty, not the free-trade turn. [Q30-B] B Correct: it links 1813 and 1833 to industrial-capital pressure against chartered monopoly. [Q30-C] C Rule-of-law maturation is not the trade-opening lens. [Q30-D] D The 1772-73 political-economy reading is broader than this specific 1813/1833 issue.

Trap: Picking a familiar historiographical label without matching it to monopoly versus free trade.

Workbook MCQ 31. Which statement most accurately captures continuity in the Council of India created in 1858?

A. All fifteen members were newly elected by Indians B. The Council contained no person connected with Company administration C. Seven of its first fifteen members represented continuity from the outgoing Company side D. The Council replaced the Governor-General with an elected president

Answer: C. [Q31-A] A The Council was not elected by Indians. [Q31-B] B The 1858 settlement retained substantial Company personnel and expertise. [Q31-C] C Correct: seven of the first fifteen members demonstrate personnel continuity beneath the change in sovereign authority. [Q31-D] D The Governor-General's office continued and acquired the additional Viceroy title.

Trap: Treating the end of Company sovereignty as the disappearance of all Company personnel and administrative continuity.

Workbook MCQ 32. Which is the most defensible synthesis of constitutional development from 1773 to 1858?

A. It was a smooth democratic expansion that steadily transferred power to Indians B. It ended Company rule in 1784 and merely renamed institutions thereafter C. It decentralised legislation from Bengal to the presidencies throughout the period D. It was a crisis-punctuated centralisation of colonial rule, moving from Company autonomy to Crown sovereignty without representative self-government

Answer: D. [Q32-A] A Indians remained excluded from effective apex representation. [Q32-B] B Pitt's India Act imposed supervision but Company rule continued until 1858. [Q32-C] C The major direction, especially in 1833, was legislative centralisation. [Q32-D] D Correct: the sequence strengthened supervision, centralisation and bureaucracy while remaining colonial and unrepresentative.

Trap: Mistaking administrative constitutional development for democratic constitutionalism.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Verified PYQ coverage

Two direct Prelims questions are covered: UPSC Prelims 2019 GS-I Q4 on the Charter Act of 1813 and UPSC Prelims 2023 GS-I Q50 on the Governor-General of India designation. No direct Mains question and no additional 2026 Prelims or GS-I Mains question is assigned to this topic. The stems and option order below follow public paper reproductions; because an official answer key is not available in the study library, each answer remains clearly labelled as inferred.

SOLVED ROUTED PRELIMS PYQs

PYQ 1 - UPSC Prelims 2019 GS-I, Q4

Question (public-paper wording): Consider the following statements about the Charter Act of 1813:

1. It ended the trade monopoly of the East India Company in India except for trade in tea and trade with China.
2. It asserted the sovereignty of the British Crown over the Indian territories held by the Company.
3. The revenues of India were now controlled by the British Parliament.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED (confidence: high): A. 1 and 2 only.

Reasoning: Statement 1 is correct because the 1813 Act opened Indian trade to other British subjects while preserving the Company's monopoly over tea and China trade. Statement 2 is correct because the Act explicitly asserted Crown sovereignty over the Company's Indian territories. Statement 3 is not supported by the Act in the form stated: Parliament deepened supervision, but Indian revenues were not simply placed under direct day-to-day parliamentary control by this statute.

PYQ 2 - UPSC Prelims 2023 GS-I, Q50

Question (public-paper wording): Which one of the following Acts of British India strengthened the Governor-General of Bengal's position and designated him as the Governor-General of India?

A. The Regulating Act B. The Pitt's India Act C. The Charter Act of 1793 D. The Charter Act of 1833

INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED (confidence: high): D. The Charter Act of 1833.

Reasoning: The Regulating Act created only the Governor-General of Fort William/Bengal. Pitt's India Act reworked the council and metropolitan supervision but did not create an all-India title. The Charter Act of 1793 renewed the existing arrangement. The Charter Act of 1833 is the statute that redesignated the office as Governor-General of India and widened its legislative-executive reach.

Evidence and answer-writing drills

Drill 1 -- Name the crisis as fiscal and political, never humanitarian

Claim: State the 1772-73 crisis as Company bankruptcy risk, an emergency government loan, and parliamentary anxiety over unaccountable patronage and mismanagement; never lead with, or imply, a humanitarian motive tied to the 1770 famine as Parliament's primary driver.

Exam move: A question asking "why did Parliament intervene in Company affairs in 1773" is answered with the financial-crisis-and-accountability mechanism first; the famine belongs in the background context, not the causal headline.

Drill 2 -- State the Regulating Act's exact institutional design, not a vague "more control" answer

Claim: Name the Governor-General of Fort William/Bengal, the four-member Council, the narrower Bengal-subordination-of-presidencies wording, the Court of Directors' reporting duty, and the Supreme Court/1774 Charter together as the Act's five components.

Exam move: A statement-based question on the Regulating Act tests these five components independently -- know which specific component each option is really describing before selecting an answer.

Drill 3 -- The Regulating Act failed on Council arithmetic, not personal failure

Claim: Name the 3-1 Hastings-Council split (1774-76) as the structural cause of failure, Monson's 1776 death as the contingent (non-statutory) resolution, and Pitt's India Act's smaller council (1784) as the actual statutory fix.

Exam move: Reject any answer attributing the Regulating Act's failure to Warren Hastings's personal competence alone; the vote-arithmetic mechanism is the examinable cause.

Drill 4 -- Handle Nand Kumar source-critically, never as settled fact

Claim: State the documented facts (the corruption accusation against Hastings, the separate 1770 forgery charge, the 1775 trial and execution, the Hastings-Impey personal closeness) and explicitly flag the "deliberate silencing" reading as a widely held but contested interpretation.

Exam move: A question inviting assessment of the Nand Kumar episode rewards naming the source-critical caution explicitly, not simply retelling the narrative as though the causal link to Hastings were proven.

Drill 5 -- Distinguish the Patna and Cossijurah jurisdictional zones precisely

Claim: Name Patna as a personal-law/civil-court jurisdiction clash and Cossijurah as a revenue-administration jurisdiction clash; state both as instances of the same underlying Supreme-Court-versus-Company-courts overlap.

Exam move: A question on "why was the Amending Act of 1781 needed" is answered by naming both cases and the general overlap they exposed, not by naming only one case.

Drill 6 -- State exactly what the 1781 Act fixed, and exactly what it left untouched

Claim: Name the four precise 1781 corrections (official-acts exemption, revenue-matter exclusion, Hindu/Muslim personal-law direction, provincial-appeal routing) and state explicitly that the Council-deadlock problem was untouched by this Act.

Exam move: Reject any answer crediting the 1781 Act with fixing the executive deadlock; that required 1784's smaller council and 1786's override power, entirely separate fixes.

Drill 7 -- Never conflate Bengal's Dual Government with Britain's dual control

Claim: Name the Bengal Dual Government (1765-72, Nawab's Nizamat vs Company's Diwani, Topic 04) and Pitt's India Act's dual control (1784 onward, Board of Control vs Court of Directors, both in Britain) as two entirely distinct institutions.

Exam move: Any option using the word "dual" in a governance-structure question must be checked against which decade, which location and which two bodies it actually names before selecting it.

Drill 8 -- Route civil-service reform through its exact four-step sequence

Claim: State the sequence precisely: an 1833 formal non-discrimination promise, an 1853 Act ending patronage and opening the competitive principle, an 1854 Macaulay Committee designing the mechanism, and a first 1855 examination operationalising it.

Exam move: Reject any answer that credits 1833 with opening the civil service in practice, or that credits 1853 alone with instantly producing full competitive recruitment; both are promise-versus-practice traps.

Drill 9 -- State the 1813 Charter Act's three provisions as independently verifiable

Claim: Name trade liberalisation (with the tea/China exception), the Crown-sovereignty assertion, and the missionary/education gesture as three separate statutory moves, each checkable on its own.

Exam move: This is this topic's single most heavily tested Act; a Prelims statement-set question should be answered statement by statement against this three-part checklist, never by a single undifferentiated "1813 was a reforming Act" impression.

Drill 10 -- Keep the 1833 Act's two centralisations separate

Claim: Name the executive/titular centralisation (Governor-General of Bengal to Governor-General of India) and the legislative centralisation (all-India law-making power concentrated in the Governor-General-in-Council) as two distinct movements that happen to arrive in the same Act.

Exam move: A question naming "the Act that created the Governor-General of India" tests the titular centralisation specifically; do not answer it by describing the Law Member or Law Commission instead, which are separate provisions of the same Act.

Drill 11 -- The 1858 Act and the Queen's Proclamation are two different documents

Claim: Name the Government of India Act, 1858 as the constitutional-legal transfer instrument (abolishing Company rule, the Board of Control and the Court of Directors, creating the Secretary of State and Council of India) and the Queen's Proclamation of 1 November 1858 as the separate political-policy announcement (non-interference in religion, treaty recognition, formal equality before law, qualified amnesty).

Exam move: A question asking specifically what the 1858 Act itself provided should not be answered with Proclamation content (religious non-interference, amnesty), and vice versa; keep the two documents' content in two separate mental boxes.

Drill 12 -- State 1858 as rupture-in-sovereignty alongside continuity-in-administration

Claim: Name the abolished apex bodies (Company, Board of Control, Court of Directors) alongside the retained or continued elements (the Governor-General's office, now also Viceroy; the 1853-55 civil-service principle; seven of the new Council of India's first fifteen members being ex-Company men) in the same answer.

Exam move: A "how much did 1858 actually change" question rewards naming both halves explicitly -- rupture at the apex, continuity below it -- rather than treating 1858 as either a total revolution or a mere formality.

Drill 13 -- Keep the topic's endpoint at 1858, not beyond it

Claim: State explicitly that the Indian Councils Act of 1861 and all later representative-council reforms are Topic 12's material, and that the Revolt of 1857's own causes and course are Topic 11's material, referenced here only as this topic's trigger.

Exam move: When a question edges toward post-1858 councils or the Revolt's own detailed narrative, name the boundary explicitly rather than silently absorbing that material as though it belonged to this topic.

Mains practice: solved model answers

Use the following answer limits: **10 marks = 150 words, 15 marks = 250 words, 20 marks = 250 words.** The counted limit applies to the **Model answer** line only; the answer-plan, marks note and improvement note sit outside the word limit.

Mains 1 - 10 marks | 150 words

Question: Examine why Parliament's 1772-73 intervention in East India Company affairs is better explained by fiscal crisis and political accountability concerns than by humanitarian motive.

Demand decoding: Show the proximate cause of intervention, distinguish background famine from immediate trigger, and connect solvency crisis to patronage-and-accountability anxiety.

Model answer: Parliament intervened in 1772-73 because the East India Company had become both a territorial sovereign in Bengal and a financially unstable corporation in Britain. The immediate trigger was the Company's cash crisis and its request for a government-backed loan in 1772, which exposed mismanagement to Parliament. British political society also feared the patronage power of returning Company "nabobs" and the constitutional anomaly of a merchant body exercising revenue, war and justice powers without settled accountability. The 1770 Bengal famine formed part of the background evidence of misgovernment, but it was not Parliament's own primary legislative trigger. The Regulating Act, 1773 therefore arose chiefly from fiscal alarm and political-accountability pressure, not from a humanitarian project to protect Bengal's peasantry.

Executable answer plan: Open with the 1772 solvency crisis, add the nabob-patronage/accountability concern, then qualify the famine as background rather than proximate cause.

Why this earns marks: It names the actual trigger (loan request), links it to British constitutional concern, and resists the common humanitarian oversimplification.

How to improve this answer: Add one named parliamentary committee of 1772 if you need a sharper evidence anchor.

Mains 2 - 10 marks | 150 words

Question: Distinguish the institutional design of the Regulating Act, 1773 from that of Pitt's India Act, 1784, with particular reference to the size of the Bengal Council.

Demand decoding: Make the comparison explicit: 1773 design, 1784 correction, and why council size mattered constitutionally.

Model answer: The Regulating Act, 1773 created a Governor-General of Fort William (Bengal) with a **four-member Council**, a structure that quickly produced deadlock because Hastings could be outvoted by a standing hostile majority. Pitt's India Act, 1784 answered by reducing the council to a **Governor-General-plus-three**, so the Governor-General now needed only one ally for a working majority. The second major design difference was metropolitan: 1773 had imposed reporting duties on the Court of Directors, but 1784 created the **Board of Control** to "superintend, direct and control" civil, military and revenue affairs from Britain. Thus 1773 was Parliament's first imperfect regulatory framework, whereas 1784 was a sharper corrective at both Bengal and London levels.

Executable answer plan: Compare under two heads: Bengal executive structure (4 vs 3 council members) and British supervisory structure (reporting duty vs Board of Control).

Why this earns marks: It distinguishes both acts institutionally instead of merely listing provisions in sequence.

How to improve this answer: Add the bounded follow-up point that the 1786 Act strengthened the Governor-General further without merging it into the 1784 reform.

Mains 3 - 15 marks | 250 words

Question: Evaluate the Charter Act of 1813 as a bundle of three distinct statutory provisions, and explain why this makes it one of this topic's most heavily tested Prelims Acts.

Demand decoding: Separate the Act's trade, sovereignty, and missionary-education provisions, then explain why that structure is ideal for statement-based questions.

Model answer: The Charter Act of 1813 matters because it combines three independently testable provisions inside one statute. **First**, it ended the Company's monopoly of trade with India for other British subjects, but **retained the tea trade and all trade with China** as Company preserves. **Second**, it asserted the "undoubted sovereignty of the Crown of the United Kingdom" over the Company's Indian territories, reinforcing Crown supremacy without yet abolishing Company administration. **Third**, it permitted Christian missionaries to enter Company territory and earmarked **one lakh rupees annually** for literature, learned Indians and useful knowledge, though actual disbursal lagged for years.

UPSC repeatedly tests this Act because each proposition can be separated into true and false statements: one may remember trade opening yet forget the tea-China exception, or recall education while missing the Crown-sovereignty assertion. The Act is therefore a compact bundle of economic, constitutional and cultural provisions whose internal distinctions reward precise elimination.

Executable answer plan: Use three subheads-trade, sovereignty, missionary-education-then end by explaining why each becomes an independent Prelims statement.

Why this earns marks: It keeps the three clauses analytically separate and links statutory detail directly to UPSC question design.

How to improve this answer: Quote the tea/China exception explicitly if you want one more high-yield precision point.

Mains 4 - 15 marks | 250 words

Question: Discuss the two distinct centralisations -- executive/titular and legislative -- introduced together by the Charter Act of 1833.

Demand decoding: Explain how 1833 centralised authority in two different ways, and do not collapse title change into law-making change.

Model answer: The Charter Act of 1833 centralised British Indian government through **two distinct but simultaneous moves**. The first was **executive/titular centralisation**: the Governor-General of Bengal became the **Governor-General of India**, with Lord William Bentinck the first holder of the all-India title. This widened the constitutional scope of the office beyond Bengal. The second was **legislative centralisation**: legislative authority for all British India was concentrated in the Governor-General-in-Council, reducing the earlier autonomy of presidency governments in law-making. The Act also added a **Law Member**, first held by Macaulay, and provided for a **Law Commission**, deepening the codification project. These developments must be kept separate because a question on "the Act that created the Governor-General of India" tests the titular shift, whereas a question on all-India legislation tests the law-making shift. Alongside both, the Act ended the Company's commercial character, but that is a third, economic change rather than part of either centralisation track.

Executable answer plan: Write under three mini-heads: titular centralisation, legislative centralisation, and bounded caveat that commercial wind-up is related but analytically separate.

Why this earns marks: It shows why 1833 is a structural turning point without flattening different constitutional changes into one slogan.

How to improve this answer: Add one line on why codification remained incomplete within 1833-1858 if the examiner expects a stronger qualification.

Mains 5 - 20 marks | 250 words

Question: Trace the evolution of the Governor-General's office from 1773 to 1858, and examine the institutional significance of each stage.

Demand decoding: Track the office chronologically and explain what each step solved: weak Bengal office, deadlock correction, all-India executive, and Crown representation.

Model answer: The Governor-Generalship is the clearest institutional ladder in this topic. **In 1773**, the Regulating Act created the Governor-General of Fort William/Bengal, with Warren Hastings its first holder, but the office was structurally weak because a four-member council could outvote it. **In 1784**, Pitt's India Act reduced the council to three members, easing the deadlock problem; **in 1786**, Cornwallis received a bounded override power and combined the office with Commander-in-Chief, strengthening executive authority further. **In 1833**, the Charter Act upgraded the office into the **Governor-General of India**, with William Bentinck first holding the all-India title alongside central legislative authority. **In 1858**, the Government of India Act retained the office but added the **Viceroy** title, with Canning becoming the first Governor-General-and-Viceroy under direct Crown rule. Each stage answered a specific institutional weakness, so the sequence shows the gradual construction of a stronger, more centralised imperial executive.

Executable answer plan: Use a four-stage ladder-1773, 1784-86, 1833, 1858-and connect every stage to the problem it corrected.

Why this earns marks: It ties title changes to institutional purpose instead of reciting names and dates in isolation.

How to improve this answer: Add the office-holders in the opening line of each stage if you want a still sharper factual frame.

Mains 6 - 20 marks | 250 words

Question: "Constitutional reform in colonial India between 1773 and 1858 was a story of parliamentary sovereignty steadily displacing corporate autonomy." Critically evaluate this statement with reference to at least four named Acts.

Demand decoding: Test both halves of the quotation-`displacing corporate autonomy` and `steadily`-using named Acts and a final qualification.

Model answer: The statement is broadly correct, but only if `steadily` is read as **crisis-punctuated** rather than smooth. The **Regulating Act, 1773** imposed reporting obligations and created a Governor-General-in-Council, signalling that Parliament would no longer ignore Company government. **Pitt's India Act, 1784** went further by creating the Board of Control, so Company administration was now politically supervised from Britain. The **Charter Act of 1813** breached monopoly by opening Indian trade to other British subjects while asserting Crown sovereignty over Company territories. The **Charter Act of 1833** ended the Company's commercial activity altogether, turning it into a purely administrative agency. Finally, the **Government of India Act, 1858** abolished Company rule, the Board of Control and the Court of Directors, completing the transfer to direct Crown sovereignty. Yet the process was not linear in tempo, and displacement of corporate autonomy did not instantly erase continuity in personnel and administrative machinery below the top.

Executable answer plan: Use four named acts as rungs, then add one sentence qualifying the word `steadily` and another distinguishing sovereignty from administrative continuity.

Why this earns marks: It answers the quotation critically rather than treating it as a prompt for mere chronology.

How to improve this answer: Add the 1793 pause or the 1853 legislative/civil-service step if you need one more nuance about uneven pace.